

Government forms panel to resolve differences between MeitY and NITI Aayog

The government has formed a committee to settle differences between NITI Aayog and Ministry of Electronics and IT (MeitY) over the artificial intelligence (AI) project. The committee is tasked with rooting out duplication of work between various government arms. The panel will also specify the role of different agencies to fast-track the implementation of AI Mission. The committee will be headed by principal scientific advisor K. Vijayraghavan.

BEL pays ₹ 2.32 billion as dividend

Defence PSU Bharat Electronics Ltd (BEL) has paid a total dividend of 340 per cent on its paid up capital to the government of India for the financial year 2018-19. M.V. Gowtama, chairman and managing director, BEL, presented the final dividend cheque amounting to ₹ 2.32 billion to defence minister Rajnath Singh.

India, Russia to team up on after-sales support of defence platforms

The Indian and Russian governments have entered into an agreement to form working groups for after-sales support of key defence platforms. The two countries have entered into a partnership to jointly manufacture spares, components and aggregates related to Russian defence equipment. Manufacturing of spares will take place in India through joint ventures. This will not only help in indigenisation but also reduce costs.

Wipro to develop 5G technology with Finnish varsity

Indian software major Wipro has tied up with University of Oulu in Finland to develop 5G technologies. According to Wipro, the

collaboration with Oulu is to focus on wireless communications in 5G/6G at GHz, THz and light-wave frequencies under the Finnish university's flagship programme.

TCS partners with Qualcomm to launch 5G innovation hub in Hyderabad

IT services major Tata Consultancy Services (TCS) has partnered with chipmaker Qualcomm to launch a 5G innovation hub in Hyderabad. The new hub will be used to build domain-specific solutions that use the power of artificial intelligence (AI), the Internet of Things (IoT) and 5G technologies to help global enterprises across industries accelerate their digital transformation journeys.

Toyota, BYD to open joint R&D centre for BEVs

According to a report by *china.org.cn*, Build Your Dreams (BYD) and Toyota Motor Corp. have signed an agreement to establish a joint company for the research and development (R&D) of battery electric vehicles (BEVs) in China. It is expected that the company will be established in 2020, and BYD and Toyota intend to transfer engineers and staff presently working in related R&D work from their respective companies to the new project.

Vivo starts manufacturing unit in Greater Noida

According to an English daily, Chinese handset maker Vivo has started a new manufacturing unit in Greater Noida under the first phase of its ₹ 75 billion investment plan in India. The company is deciding on the prospects of exporting from its Indian facilities. The new facility will increase the production capacity of the company to 33.4 million devices annually from the previous figure of 25 million and create 2000 new jobs in the state.

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Calendar of Forthcoming Electronics Fairs/Exhibitions/Seminars/Events

Name, Date and Venue	Topics	Contact address for details
Electronics Show 2020 May 8-10, 2020 Ptak Warsaw Expo, Nadarzyn, Poland	Consumer electronics and new technology trade show in Poland	Ptak Warsaw Expo Website: https://electronics-show.com
NIWeek 2020 May 18-20, 2020 Austin, Texas, USA	Annual global conference for graphical system design organised by National Instruments	National Instruments Website: www.ni.com

Since this information is subject to change, all those interested are advised to ascertain the details from the organisers before making any commitment.

with the government scrapping import duty on the biggest component open cell panel, or displays, according to an English daily.

The South Korean electronics company is about to sign a deal with contract manufacturer Dixon Technologies to manufacture TV sets up to 1.39m (55-inch) in screen size. These account for more than 85 per cent of the Indian market. The company is also evaluating options with other contract manufacturers to further expand local TV production in India.

Samsung is also assessing whether it can restart the TV line in its Chennai

plant that was shut in October last year after the government imposed duty on open cell TV panels. The company had then started importing finished TV sets from its plant in Vietnam through the free trade agreement (FTA) route.

Tesla to expand world's largest lithium-ion battery production in Australia

According to media reports, Tesla and power producer Neoen will expand by fifty per cent the world's largest lithium-ion battery production in South Australia to ensure additional grid stability.

Neoen will expand Hornsdale Power Reserve battery unit, also known as Tesla Big Battery, which Tesla started to build two years ago. At the time, Tesla was selected through a competitive bidding process to provide a 100MW/129MWh powerpack system to be paired with Neoen's Hornsdale Wind Farm near Jamestown. Now Neoen, supported by Tesla, will expand the battery unit by 50MW/64.5MWh to offer additional grid stability and cut electricity costs for consumers.

The expansion is expected to be completed in the first half next year. In its first year of operation, Tesla Big Battery has saved consumers more than US\$34 million (AU\$50 million), and the expansion will lead to additional savings for consumers.

The project is supported by South Australian government, which is giving grants from its Grid Scale Storage Fund. The battery expansion project will also be the first battery project in Australia to benefit from debt financing support from Clean Energy Finance Corp. (CEFC).